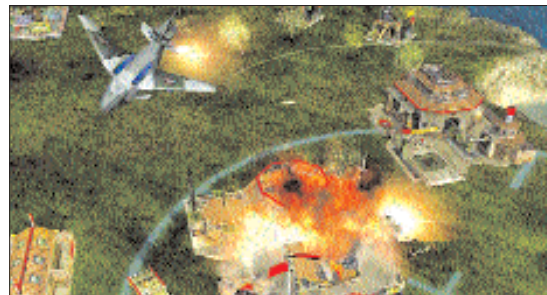


Time For A Promotion?

THE ORIGINAL PREMISE of C&C Generals was that you took on the role of a general commanding his forces against certain opponents. Unfortunately, that never really came through while playing the game. It felt more like Red Alert 2 in true 3D. However, this expansion pack fulfils the promise of Generals by allowing you to be one of nine generals who are spread across the original factions, each having their own strengths, weaknesses, and wisecracks. Fortunately, these differences are not subtle. So a battle plan that works for one will most likely fail for another, even within the same faction.

Mirroring reality, the dark terrorist organisation in the game employs cheap units that appear less powerful. Pound for pound, US weapon systems are indeed much better, but the overall impact of the GLA is always underestimated. The faction is the fastest at assembling an army.

The graphics are really impressive, and the game automatically adjusts to give you playable performance at all times. Units also have had a little brain adjustment. Their AI is now smart enough to retaliate if someone attacks the base. If you have never played Generals, do that first. It's a fun game,



and a big step up for the C&C series. If you don't fall in love with Generals, chances are that Zero Hour won't appeal much more. It simply provides new stuff that lends more diversity to the game, giving you enough variation to keep you playing happily for far longer.

Command & Conquer Generals: Zero Hour

Publisher **EA Games**
Developer **EA Games**
Website **www.eagames.com/official/cc/generals/us**
System requirements **800 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, GeForce2 video card, 1.8 GB free space**
Price **Rs 999**

Your Chance To Beat Osama's Men...

CS:CZ IS the standalone installment of the Counter-Strike mod. This time around, your teammates and the enemy are not human, but computer-controlled bots, featured in a series of single-player missions interconnected by the most pathetic storyline in history.

Counter-Strike is essentially a struggle between two teams—Terrorists and Counter-Terrorists (CTs). CS:CZ provides 18 levels; in some you need to prevent the terrorists from planting a bomb while in others, you need to rescue some hostages.

Levels are opened in sets of three—to unlock the next set, you need to secure the current set by beating the terrorists and completing the tasks set in each.

The AI can get pretty bad with idiotic CT bots getting in the way all the time. And they constantly want to perform heroics inspired by Sunny Deol movies!



On the other hand, the more you play this game, the more intelligent the terrorists seem to get.

If you don't have any humans to play CS with, this game is a just about decent substitute.

Counter-Strike: Condition Zero

Publisher **Vivendi Universal**
Developer **Turtle Rock Studios**
Web site **www.cs-conditionzero.com**
System requirements **500 MHz CPU, 96 MB RAM, 16 MB video card, 500 MB HDD space**
Price **Rs 799**

Start Your Engines!

THIS IS THE first NFS game driven by a story (at least, something that tries to be one). NFSU2 throws in a whole city with five distinct parts that you have to unlock while following the storyline. Races modes consist of the legendary Drag, Circuit, Sprint and Drift races, with a notable addition being Street X, a combination of the Circuit and Drift modes. Then there's Time Attack, where you have to reach complete certain objectives in the given time.

NFSU2 looks splendid, with fog, and extra particle effects making their debut. The crash effects have not improved much though, even with the introduction of a "different" camera angle. Due to the lack of damage modelling, the only enjoyment you can get the sound of shearing metal. Overall, the graphics aren't much better



than NFSU, and impose a severe performance drop. Satisfy your speed addiction through this game, not in the real world. Drive safe.

Courtesy SKOAR!

Need For Speed Underground 2

Publisher **Electronic Arts**
Developer **EA Canada**
Web site **www.needforspeed.com**
System Requirements **9933 MHz CPU, GeForce2, 256 MB RAM, 2 GB HDD space**

5 TOP SELLING GAMES

- 1. NFS Underground 2**
Rs 1,299
Gayatri Impex Pvt Ltd
- 2. FIFA 2005**
Rs 1,299
Gayatri Impex Pvt Ltd
- 3. The Incredibles**
Rs 699
- 4. Half Life 2**
Rs 1,499
Milestone Interactive Software Pvt Ltd
- 5. Sims 2**
Rs 1,299

List Courtesy: Crossword Mumbai